

County health clinics severely cut back

Reduction leaves only six full-service sites, a loss for poor and uninsured patients.

By MEG TANAKA

Because of budget cuts, the Los Angeles County Department of Public Health has ended clinical services at seven of its public health clinic sites.

As of Feb. 27, the county no longer is providing services such as vaccinations, sexually transmitted infection testing and treatment, or tuberculosis diagnosis and specialty TB care at the affected locations, according to county officials and a department fact sheet.

The sites losing clinical services are Antelope Valley in Lancaster; the Center for Community Health (Leavy) in San Pedro, Curtis R. Tucker in Inglewood, Hollywood-Wilshire, Pomona, Dr. Ruth Temple in South Los Angeles, and Torrance. Services will continue to be provided by the six remaining public health clinics and through nearby community clinics.

The changes are the result of about \$50 million in funding losses, according to official county statements.

“That pushed us to make the very difficult decision to end clinical services at seven of our sites,” said Dr. Anish Mahajan, chief deputy director of the L.A. County Department of Public Health.

Mahajan said the department selected clinics with relatively lower patient volumes. Over the last month, he said, the department has sent letters to patients about the changes and referred them to unaffected county clinics, nearby federally qualified health centers or other community providers. According to Mahajan, for tuberculosis patients, particularly those requiring directly observed therapy, public health nurses will continue visiting patients.

Public health clinics form part of the county’s health- [See Clinics, A8]



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TRADERS work on the floor of the New York Stock Exchange, top. In the Oval Office, above, German Chancellor Friedrich Merz meets with President Trump.

Democrats urged to quit tight contest for governor

Party chief warns of split vote, all-GOP fall race. Nonwhite candidates push back.

By SEEMA MEHTA

Fearing the prospect of a Republican winning California’s gubernatorial race, state Democratic Party Chair Rusty Hicks on Tuesday urged his party’s candidates who lack a viable path to victory to drop out.

“It is imperative that every candidate honestly assess the viability of their candidacy and campaign,” Hicks wrote in an open letter to the politicians vying to replace termed-out Gov. Gavin Newsom. “I recognize my suggestions are hard for many to contemplate and may be even viewed as overly harsh by some.”

Hicks did not name the Democrats he wants out of the race, but such a public admonishment by a party leader is rare in California politics.

Even though the odds are relatively low, California cannot risk having a Republican elected as the next governor at a time when President Trump is in the White House, Hicks said.

“[S]o much is at stake in our Nation and so many are counting on the leadership of California Democrats to stand up and speak out at this historic moment,” Hicks wrote. “California’s leader-

ship on the world stage is significantly harder if a Democrat is not elected as our next Governor.”

Hicks urged Democrats languishing at the bottom of the field of candidates to drop out before the Friday deadline to officially file to run for governor — to ensure their names do not appear on the June primary ballot.

Within hours of the letter’s release former state Controller Betty Yee and state Supt. of Public Instruction Tony Thurmond — two of the candidates lowest in recent opinion polls — officially filed papers to run for governor.

Thurmond, who is Black and Latino, posted a video accusing the party of urging [See Candidates, A8]



MYUNG J. CHUN Los Angeles Times

TONY PEREZ, a robot wrangler for Serve Robotics, wipes the lens on a delivery bot to ready it for work.

Robots took his job, gave him a new one

By NILESH CHRISTOPHER

Charlie Snodgrass used to be a gig driver, delivering burritos and pad Thai around Los Angeles. Today, he handles the robots that do his old job.

He is one of the first of a new class of workers, a robot wrangler paid to care for and train AI-powered bots as they learn to work in the real world.

At 5:45 a.m., in a small warehouse in West Hollywood, Snodgrass tends to rows of identical delivery robots standing wheel to wheel, 150 in all. The quiet morning is punctuated by the high-pitched swoosh

sounds of the robots powering up and the occasional beep.

Each robot is topped with a colored disc cone — a visual triage system for identifying the status of each machine. A green cone indicates the robot is checked, its sensors are clean and its battery is charged. An orange cone means it’s waiting for tech support.

Snodgrass is in a rush. He has to load 27 healthy robots from Serve Robotics into a U-Haul truck and deliver them around L.A. before 7:15.

Snodgrass walks up to a robot named Singta and begins his morning check: Battery charged to at least 70%? [See Wranglers, A10]

Mexico seems to change strategy

The death of ‘El Mencho’ suggests the ‘hugs not bullets’ era is over. Just don’t call this a war on drugs.

By Patrick J. McDonnell and Kate Linthicum

REPORTING FROM MEXICO CITY

In the last year, Mexican troops have been deployed across the country to quell narco-violence, arresting legions of cartel operatives, seizing tons of illicit drugs and busting hundreds of clandestine laboratories.

Skippping the usual extradition process, Mexico shipped scores of cartel suspects to the United States to face justice, an unprecedented step.

And, in the most sensational recent blow to organized crime, Mexican special forces last month tracked down and killed Nemesis Rubén Oseguera Cervantes, known as “El Mencho,” the long-elusive boss of the notorious Jalisco New Generation cartel.

A return to the war on drugs?

No way, President Claudia Sheinbaum insists. “We want peace, not war,” she said last week. “The strategy has not changed.”

Many beg to differ.

Opposition lawmakers and others are celebrating what they call Sheinbaum’s de facto break with the controversial “hugs not bullets” approach of former President Andrés Manuel López Obrador, Sheinbaum’s predecessor and mentor.

López Obrador ditched the militarized “war on drugs” of previous administrations, which he said only inflamed violence and turned Mexico “into a graveyard.” He focused instead on attacking the root causes of crime, including poverty and scant opportunities for the young.

Many mocked his experiment as a failure: During López Obrador’s six-year term, homicides and disappearances reached record levels and cartels expanded their turf. [See Sheinbaum, A3]

Oil jumps, stocks fall with further strikes on Iran

Trump acknowledges economic pain and slams allies he says are not helping his effort.

By ANA CEBALLOS AND NABIH BULOS

WASHINGTON — The United States plunged further into conflict with Iran on Tuesday as a new round of strikes heightened fears of an expanding war in the Middle East, sending markets reeling and oil prices soaring and drawing urgent calls from European leaders for a plan forward.

President Trump acknowledged during an Oval Office appearance that the public would feel some economic pain as fighting continues to threaten areas that are critical to the world’s oil and natural gas production.

“As soon as this ends, those prices are going to drop, I believe lower than ever before,” Trump said, though he did not provide a clear time frame for when the conflict might end.

As the war stretched into its fourth day on Tuesday, Israel struck Iranian missile launch facilities and weapon factories and Iran retaliated across the Persian Gulf region, including attacks on U.S. diplomatic sites in Saudi Arabia, Kuwait and Dubai.

The conflict simultaneously set off alarms in the global markets, prompting stocks in Europe and Asia to

plunge and the S&P 500 to drop nearly 1% after falling as much as 2.5% in early trading.

European governments were also forced to contend with the fallout, with some countries increasing their military presence in the region as their actions are closely monitored by Trump, who publicly singled out countries that he thought had been helpful in his war efforts so far.

“Spain has been terrible,” Trump told reporters in the Oval Office while threatening to “cut off all trade with Spain” after he said the country had denied American forces access to its military bases.

Trump said he was “not happy with the U.K. either” and complained about not being allowed to use a military base on Diego Garcia in the Chagos Islands. Without access to that military base, Trump said American planes were forced to fly “many extra hours.”

“We were very surprised. This is not Winston Churchill that we’re dealing with,” Trump said. Churchill served as Britain’s prime minister during World War II.

As Trump threatened [See Iran, A7]

California GOP lawmakers’ stance

Incumbents facing tough races in redrawn congressional districts back the war. **NATION, A4**

Israel doubts war will be short-lived

Being mired in a months-long conflict could pose political risks for Trump.

By MICHAEL WILNER

NEW YORK — U.S. and Israeli officials are privately casting doubt on projections from the Trump administration that the war with Iran could end within a matter of weeks — instead warning that a months-long campaign may be required to destroy the country’s ballistic missile capabilities and install a pliant government, multiple sources told The Times.

The prospect of extended combat creates political risks and uncertainties for President Trump, whose penchant for dramatic, short-term military operations has suddenly given way to a full-scale assault on the Islamic Republic, shocking a MAGA base that for years supported his calls to end forever wars in the Middle East.

One Israeli official told The Times — despite internal guidance among Israeli officials to adhere to the U.S. president’s stated time

frame — that the war “definitely could be longer” than the four-week window that Trump repeatedly offered to reporters.

A U.S. official said that in private conversations, top administration officials presume the campaign will require a longer runway now that remnants of Iran’s government have chosen to resist rather than acquiesce to Washington.

Protracted war was always a possibility. Trump was presented with U.S. intelligence assessments gaming out the potential conflict that emphasized how highly unpredictable the results of an attack would be — an analysis the intelligence community believes has been borne out on the ground in the chaotic early days of the conflict.

A longer conflict could create diplomatic space between Trump and Israel’s prime minister, Benjamin Netanyahu, who has advocated for the overthrow of the Islamic Republic for more than 30 years.

The Israeli leader has succeeded in convincing Trump to take military actions in Iran that American presidents have rejected for decades, from bombing its [See Conflict, A7]

Dad of shooting suspect convicted

Colin Gray, whose son is accused of killing four at a Georgia high school, is found guilty. **NATION, A8**

Oscar voters may not be watching

The rule to see every film in a category before voting has work-around. **ENTERTAINMENT, E1**

Weather

Partly sunny. L.A. Basin: 70/55. **B6**

Markets **A10**
Opinion Voices **A12**



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ROBERT GAUTHIER L.A. Times

CLAYTON Kershaw in a 2025 farewell speech.

Kershaw capping career with USA

Dodgers legend excited to fulfill his dream of pitching in World Baseball Classic. **SPORTS, B10**

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